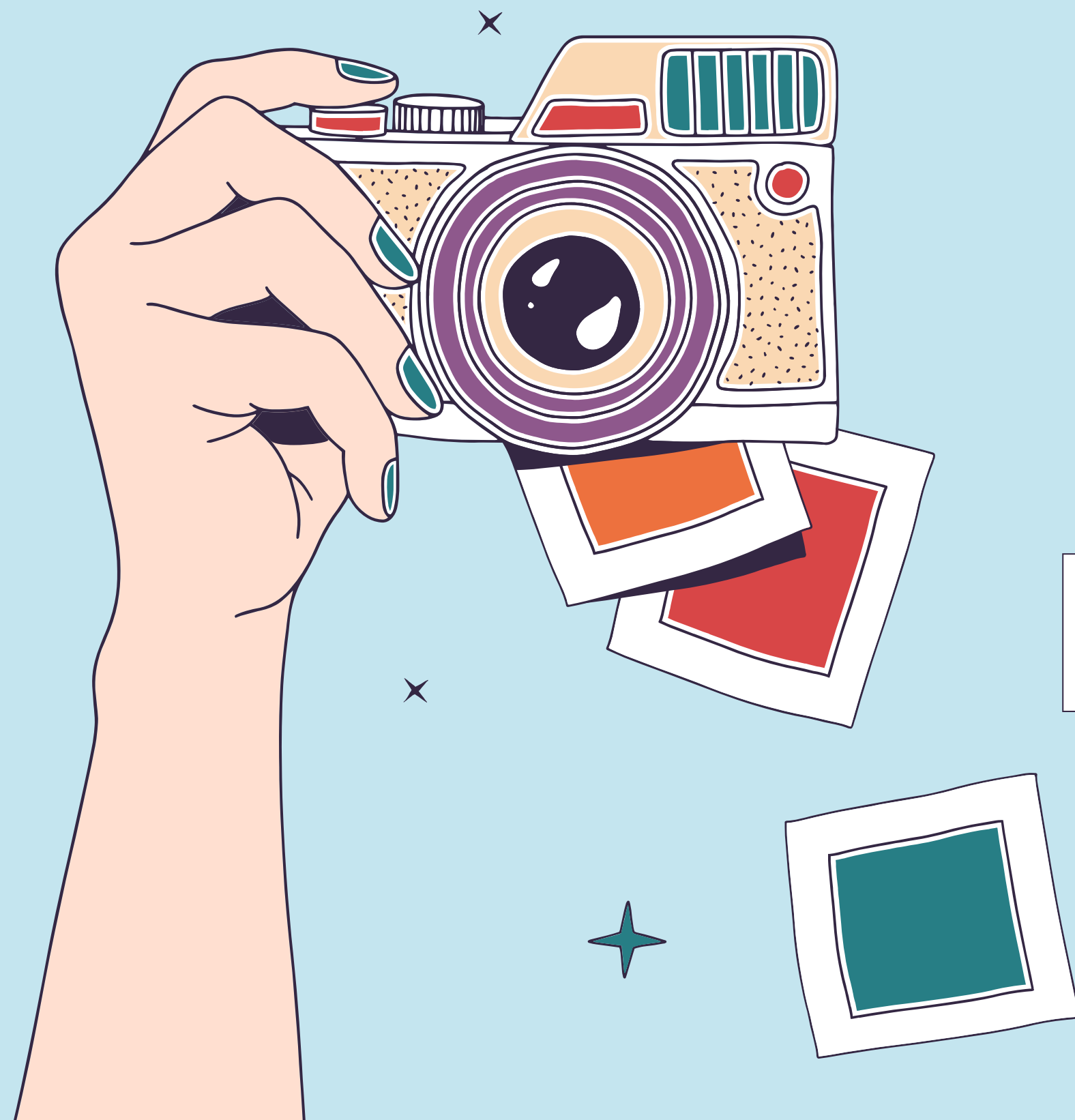
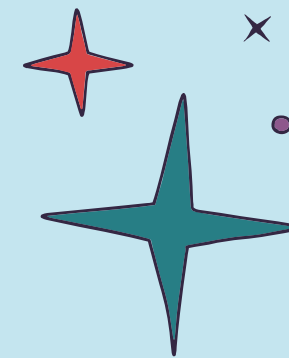
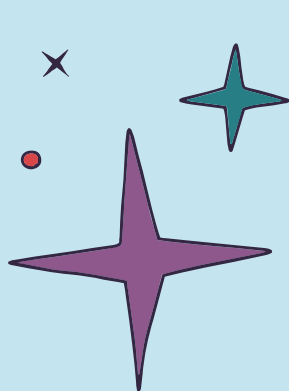




FRAME

Memories shouldn't be work!

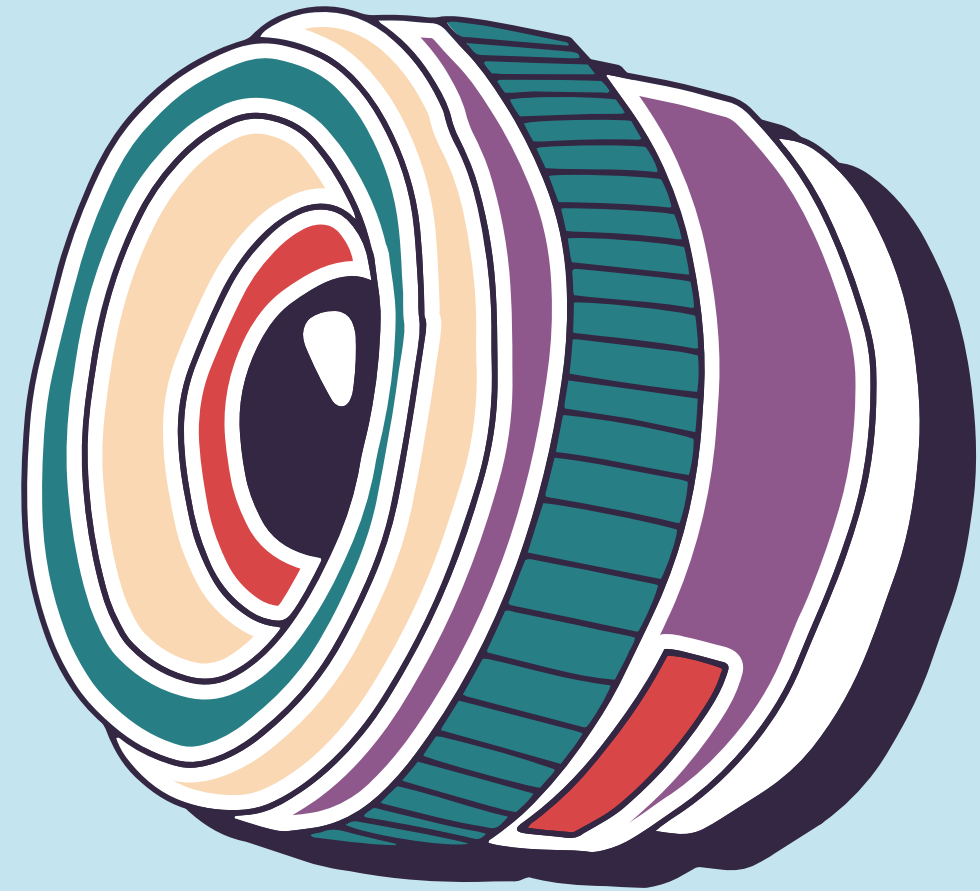


table of content





intro



The people behind FRAME



GAVIN CAO

loves animals, food & nature
lowkey a farmer :)



RACHIT GUPTA

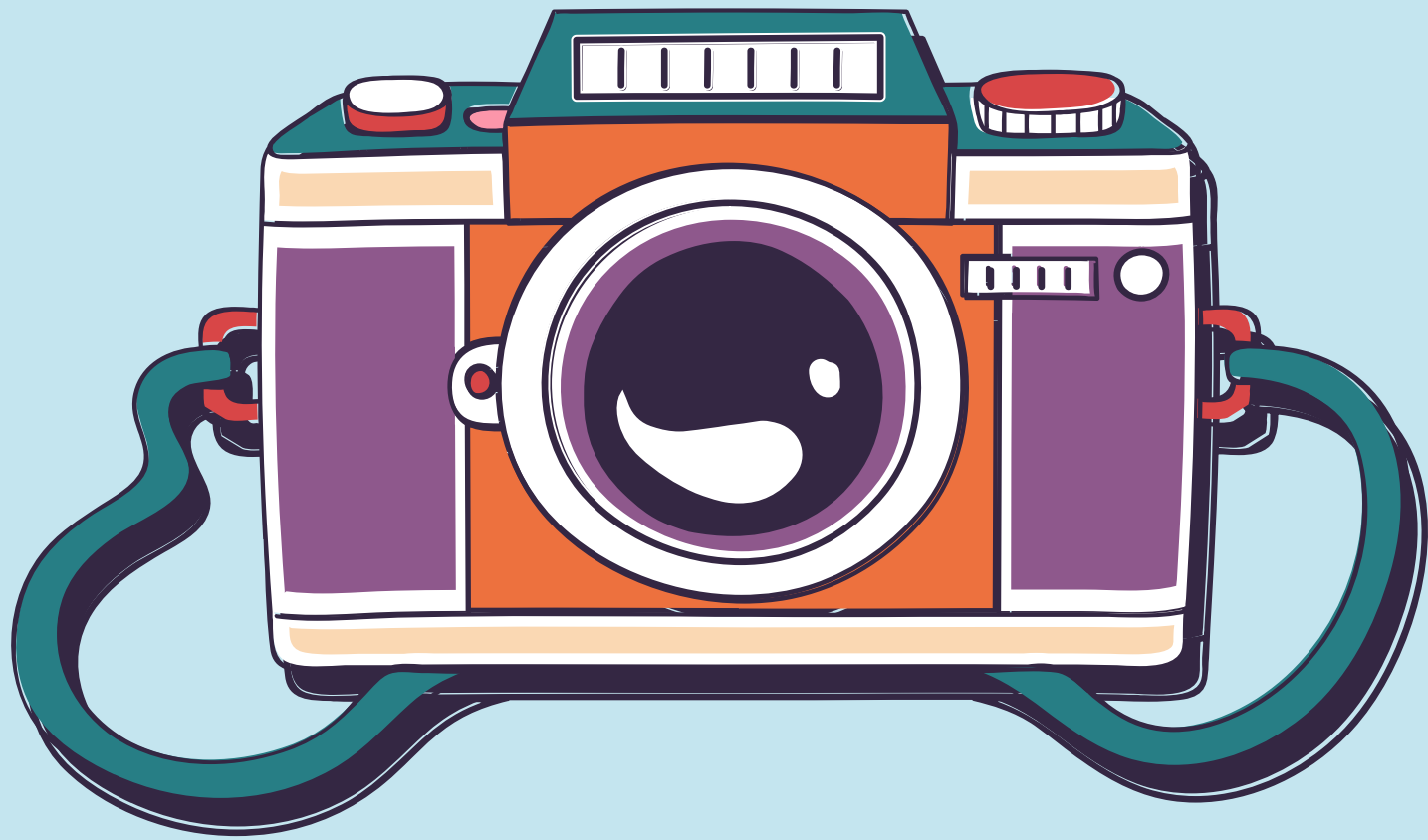
loves to drive, travel, and
click pictures!!



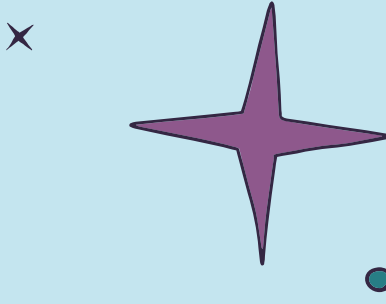
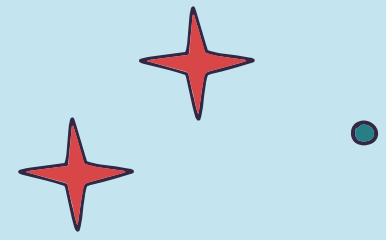
ZEEL PATEL

loves to sleep, eat
and repeat

problem statement



- Photo sharing breaks down after the moment, turning memories into manual labor involving sorting, app-switching, and follow-ups instead of enjoyment.
- People lose confidence once photos are shared, worrying about who has access, how long they'll have it, and whether boundaries are respected over time.
- The burden falls on one "default sharer", who becomes a human bridge across iOS and Android, sacrificing time and mental energy to keep everyone included.



FRAME

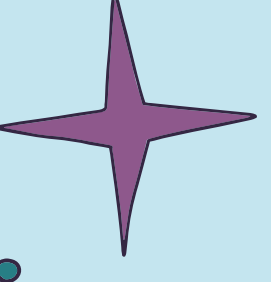
SHARING MEMORIES MADE SIMPLE



Value Proposition Statement

Frame transforms scattered photos into shared, organized memories by automatically collecting, curating, and synchronizing albums across groups

Solution



Frame turns scattered event photos on iOS or Android into unified shared albums automatically. Frame combines intelligent event clustering, privacy-focused facial detection, and cross-platform synchronization to remove the burden of sorting and ensure memories reach the intended audience effortlessly.



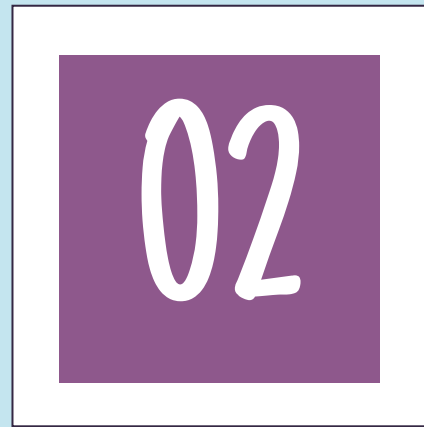


our proposed solution is cross-platform intentional sharing

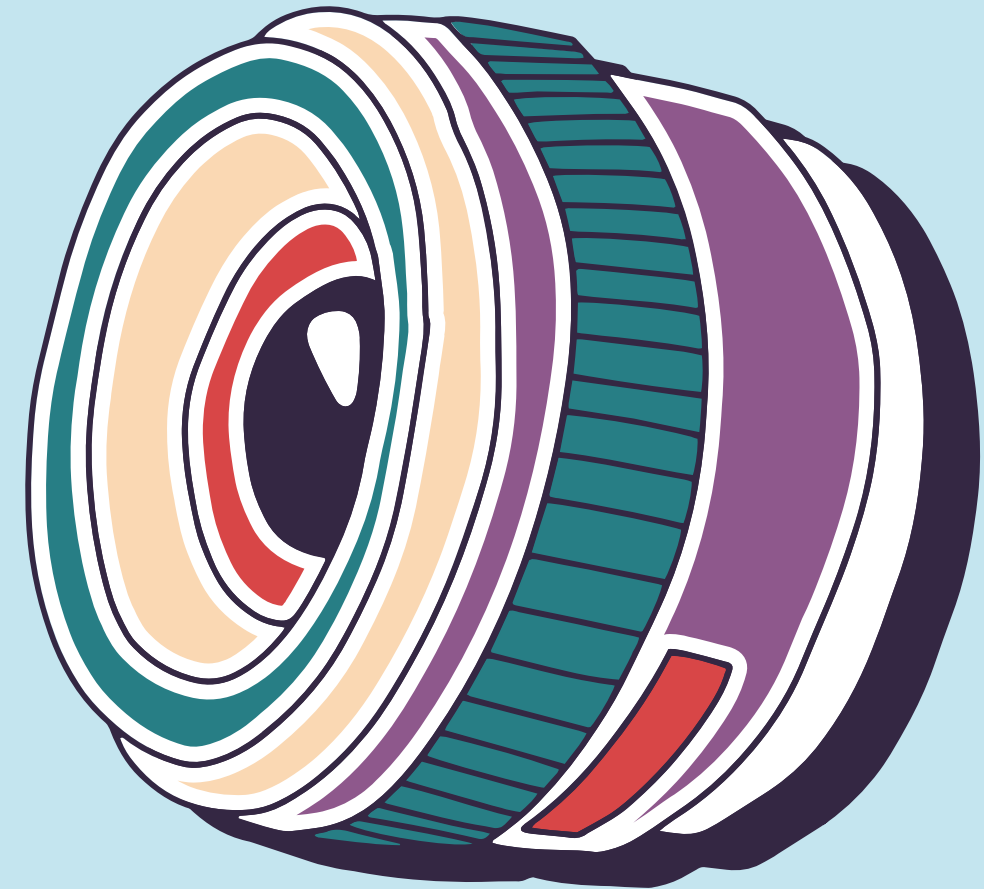


solution

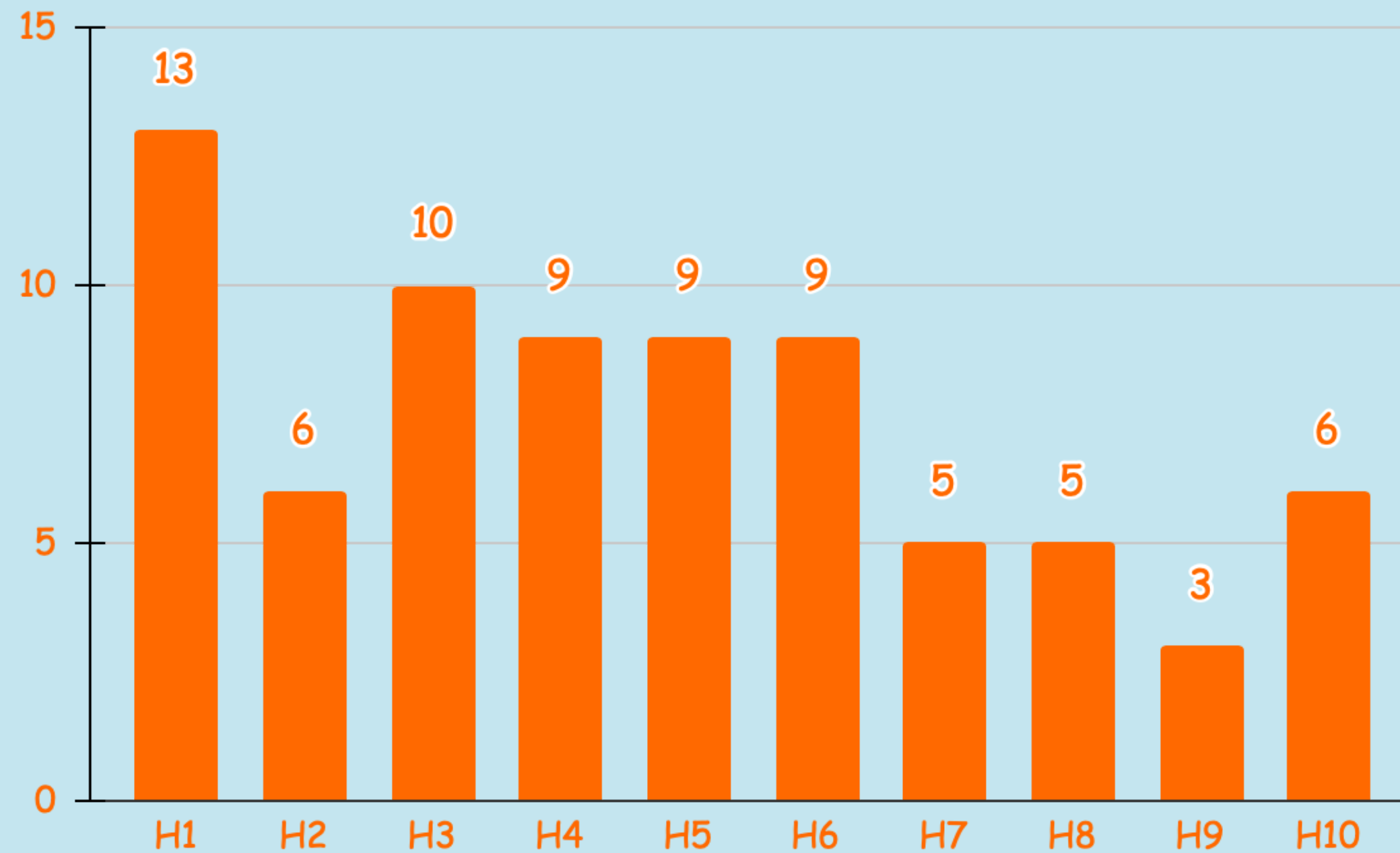
Frame is a cross-platform photo sharing experience designed to keep memories effortless after the moment ends. It removes the burden of manual sorting, app-switching, and follow-ups by automatically creating shared albums and making audience visibility intentional and clear. Instead of turning one person into the “default sharer,” Frame helps groups share photos seamlessly across iOS and Android without losing trust, time, or momentum.



heuristic evaluation results



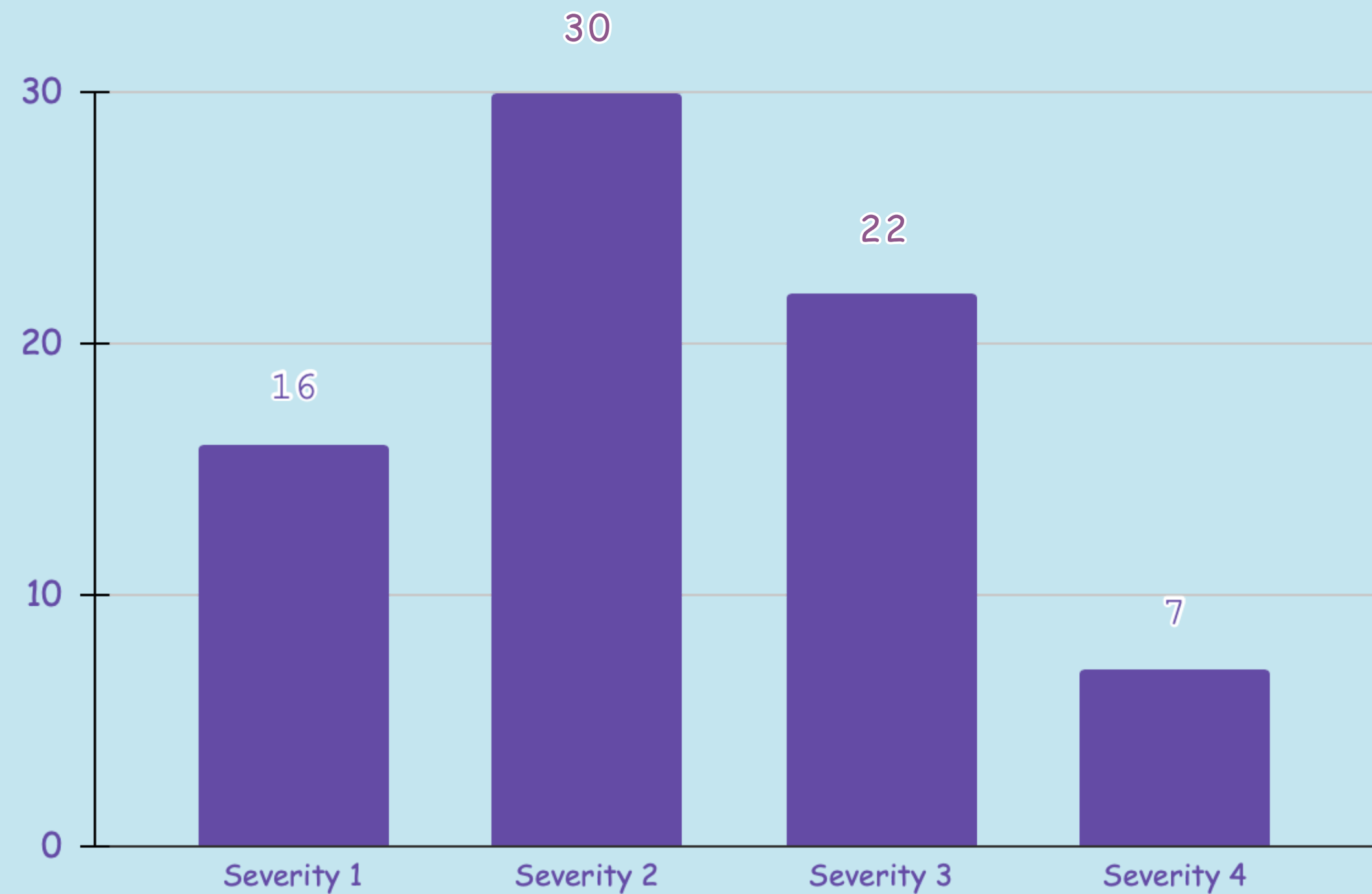
Summary of all Violations by Heuristics



Biggest Pain Points with respect to Heuristics:

- H1: Visibility of system status
- H3: User control and freedom
- H4: Consistency and standards
- H5: Error prevention
- H6: Recognition rather than recall

Summary of all Violations by Severity



Biggest Pain Points with respect to Severity:

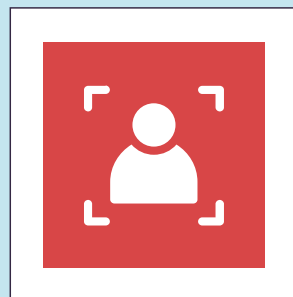
- Severity 2: Minor
- Severity 3: Major
- Severity 4: UI Catastrophe

Key Changes & Justifications



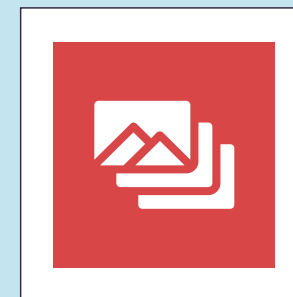
Add Recovery and Confirmation for Destructive Actions

Justification: Prevents irreversible mistakes and aligns with Error Prevention and User Control heuristics



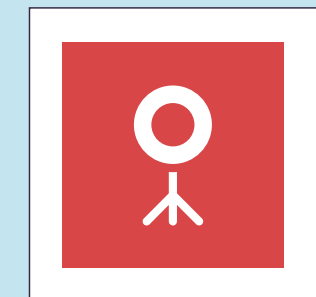
Improve System Feedback for Long or Background Processes

Justification: Clear feedback reduces uncertainty and builds user trust, especially during long operations.



Strengthen Interaction Affordances and Recognizability

Justification: Improves recognition over recall and prevents task-blocking confusion.



Clarify Permission and Privacy Decisions

Justification: Reduces hesitation and aligns system language with real-world mental models.

Severity 4 Violations

Violation	Status	Justification
During photo import, the app shows a full-screen 'HOLD ON' loading screen with only a spinner and the text 'Importing your pictures...' There is no progress bar, percentage, photo count, or estimated completion time.	Done	After further research into the native iOS permissions flow, we found that granting photo access does not require an import process; the app is simply granted access to the existing memory locations. As a result, we removed the loading screen.
When a user selects 'Discard' on an auto-curated album notification, the album is permanently deleted with no undo, no confirmation dialog, and no recovery path. The action is irreversible.	Done	Implement a 30-day 'Recently Discarded' bin mirroring iOS Photos so users can recover accidentally dismissed or declined albums
The 'Allow All Photos' option has no scope warning. There is no indication that this includes private, sensitive, or unrelated photos, and no explanation of which photos will be visible to others vs. kept private for AI analysis only.	Rejected	This behavior is a native iOS feature rather than functionality implemented by our app so we can't change that. However, we included a Change Permissions page that allows users to update or modify their permission settings at a later time.
Across the prototype, only certain blue-highlighted elements are clickable, but the screens themselves do not always make that interaction rule obvious.	Rejected	This is just Figma functionality not implemented by our app

*only four are shown here because the remaining issues were essentially variations of the same patterns

Severity 3 Violations

Violation	Status	Justification
When Frame auto-creates an album in the background, the only feedback is a push notification. There is no in-app status indicator on the Albums page showing that background processing occurred or is occurring.	Done	Now on the Dashboard Page, you will see a Notification if there is a new album. Albums Page now has a New Album instance for any new album not yet accepted, with quick buttons to accept or decline, & click card to review.
The original low-fi used 'SYNC FRAME WITH YOUR GALLERY' as the trigger to set up photo access. The word 'Sync' is technical jargon that does not map to how users think about granting an app permission to see their photos.	Rejected	This was the screen we had before we made changes in the medium fidelity prototype we now have a native OS-style permissions pop up instead of old internal import, so this violation is not up to date with our recent figma.
Once the user taps 'Allow All Photos' and import begins, there is no cancel button on the 'HOLD ON' importing screen. The user cannot interrupt or pause the import process.	Done	Like mentioned in the Severity 4 issues, we removed the Loading screen. However, we included a Change Permissions page that allows users to update or modify their permission settings at a later time.
The notification interaction model is inconsistent between tasks. Task 1's long-press shows Accept/Decline. Task 2's long-press shows Keep/Discard/Review. These are different affordances on the same gesture performing conceptually similar actions with no contextual explanation.	Done	This was addressed by standardizing notification actions across tasks. Action labels were unified to Accept, Decline, and Edit to ensure consistent affordances for similar interactions.

Severity 3 Violations

Violation	Status	Justification
In the Edit Album screen, the People section shows circular avatar bubbles with no names displayed beneath them. Users must remember or recall who each avatar represents without any visible label.	Done	Created a brand new Edit Album Page with better people management
There is no onboarding tutorial, tooltip, or help system during the initial photo import setup. New users receive a single permission prompt and are immediately placed in the import flow with no explanation of what Frame will do with their photos or what to expect.	Done	Added an extra screen with better wording and added information on how Frame will use and access the photos that our app has been granted permissions for
On the Edit Album screen, the main path forward is clear through the Done button, but there is not an equally clear Cancel or Discard Changes option for users who change their minds.	Done	We implemented a new feature so that now if you try to go back on after making some changes, it will prompt you first with a dialogue if you want to discard the changes or not
On the Edit Album screen, users are expected to use a small pencil icon to edit the People section instead of being able to tap the participant circles directly.	Rejected	This was the screen we had before we made changes in the medium fidelity prototype, so this violation is not up to date with our recent figma.

Severity 3 Violations

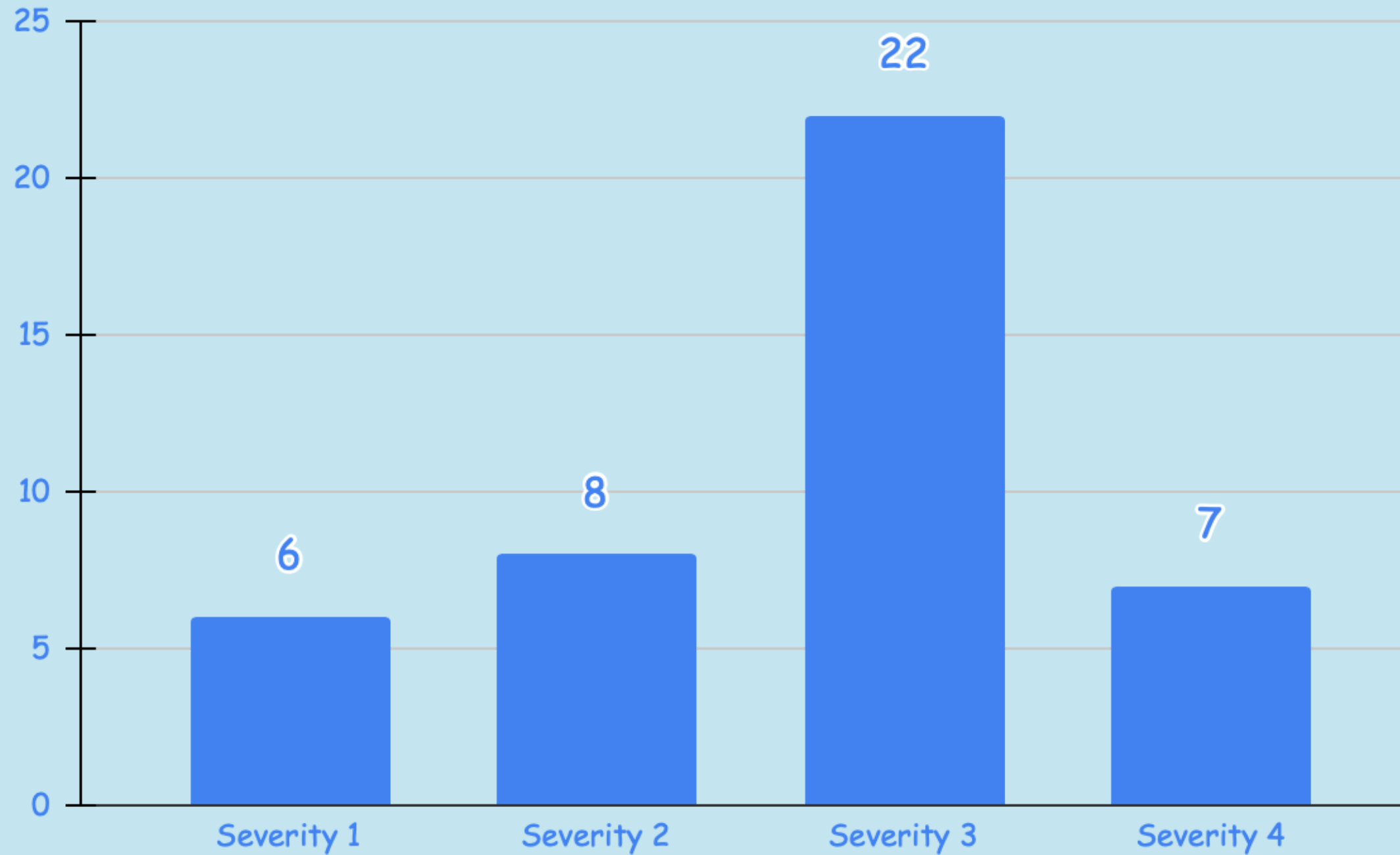
Violation	Status	Justification
In the Selected Photos path, the user appears to choose items one by one from a dense photo grid, but there are no efficient shortcuts such as Select All, Deselect All, or album-based grouping.	Rejected	This interaction is controlled by the native iOS photo permission interface and cannot be modified by the app. Also, the OS interface already provides album navigation and multi-photo selection capabilities.
If a user denies photo access or ends up selecting no photos, the prototype does not clearly show what error message or recovery guidance they would see next.	Rejected	According to our app, this is not a form of error, this is solely a users choice, they can still get access to the app and be sent photo albums. This can always be changed in the Change Permissions page.
When selecting REVIEW, the app implicitly choses to KEEP the album rather than let the user choose to keep or discard it after the review.	Done	Clicking the notification, you will land on a new review page where you have options to (Accept, Decline & Edit)

*only some are shown here because the remaining issues were essentially variations of the same patterns

Few of the Severity 1 & 2 Violations

Violation	Status	Justification
Trying to go back after clicking KEEP sends you to the app home screen instead of your phone home screen.	Done	For auto created albums we removed the hold down option, just clicking the notification takes you to the frame app where the choice of Accept, Decline and Edit option can be made. Additionally, for the Accept and Decline option when someone shares an album with you, they both redirect you to the iPhone Home Screen and clicking on the notification opens the album for further review.
The only way to accept or decline a shared album is via the long-press notification. There is no in-app inbox or pending albums section where users can respond to album invitations if they dismissed the notification.	Done	As mentioned in the severity 3 violations, now on the Dashboard Page, you will see a Notification if there is a new album.
The importing screen says things like "Hold on" or shows photos being imported, but it does not show clear progress such as percent complete, number of photos left, or time remaining.	Done	Like mentioned in the Severity 4 issues, we removed the Loading screen after researching the native iOS permission flow
If a user declines a shared album, the flow appears to return them to Albums with no clear place to revisit that invitation later.	Done	We fixed this in Severity 4 violations by implementing a 30-day 'Recently Discarded' bin mirroring iOS Photos so users can recover accidentally dismissed or declined albums

Fixed Heuristics

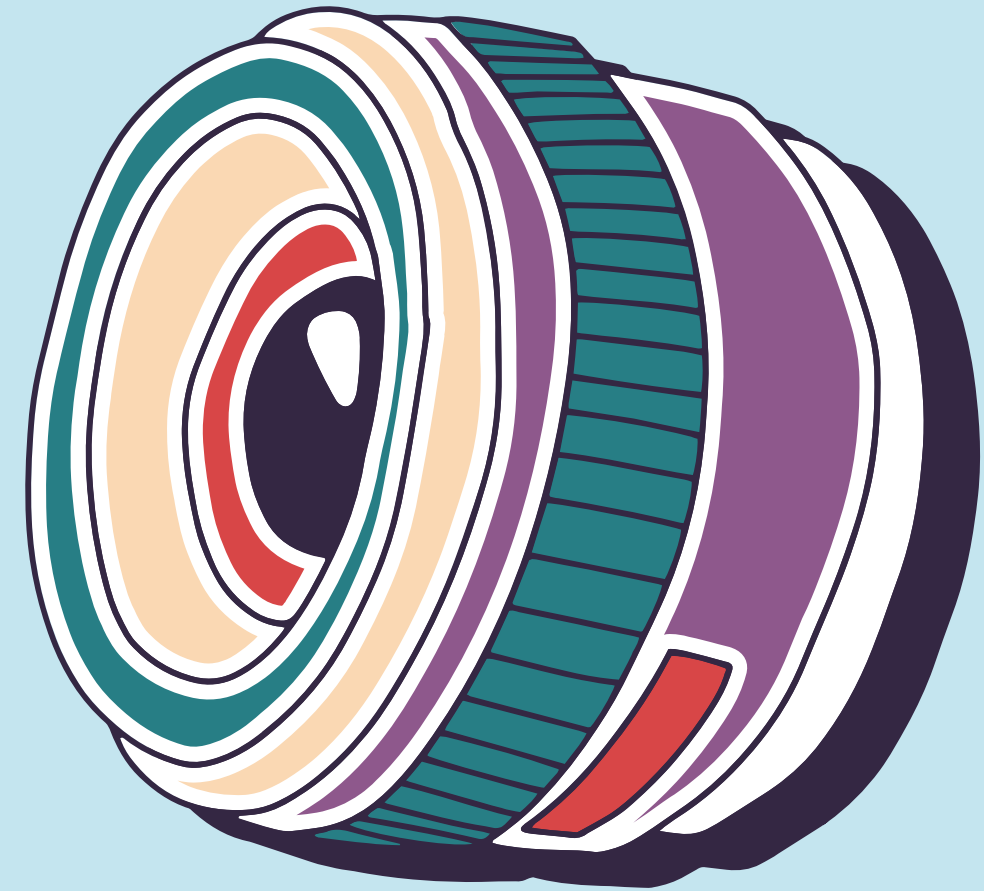


All Justified with Respect to Severity:

- All Severity 3 & 4 violations are either Fixed or Rejected with Justification
- Few Severity 2 & 1 Violations fixed too



ui revisions



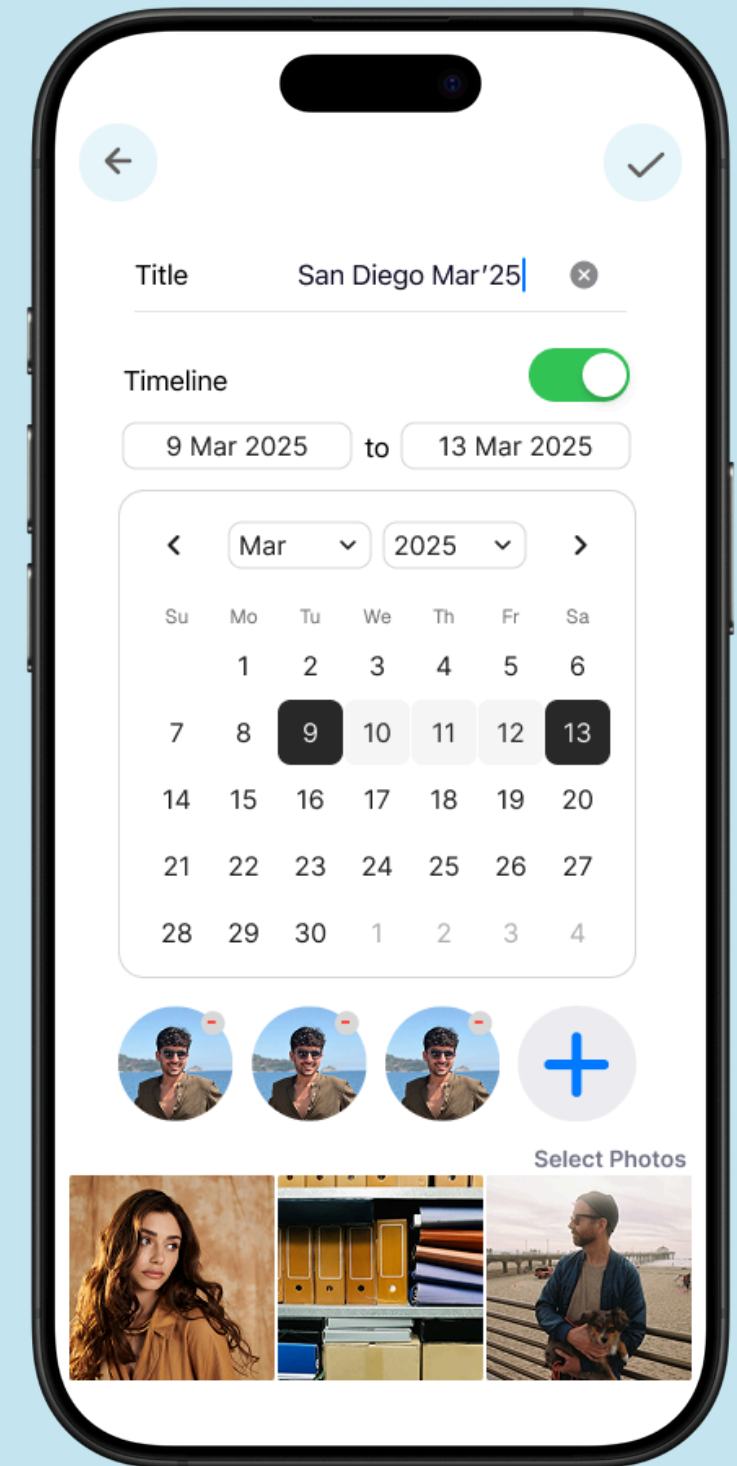
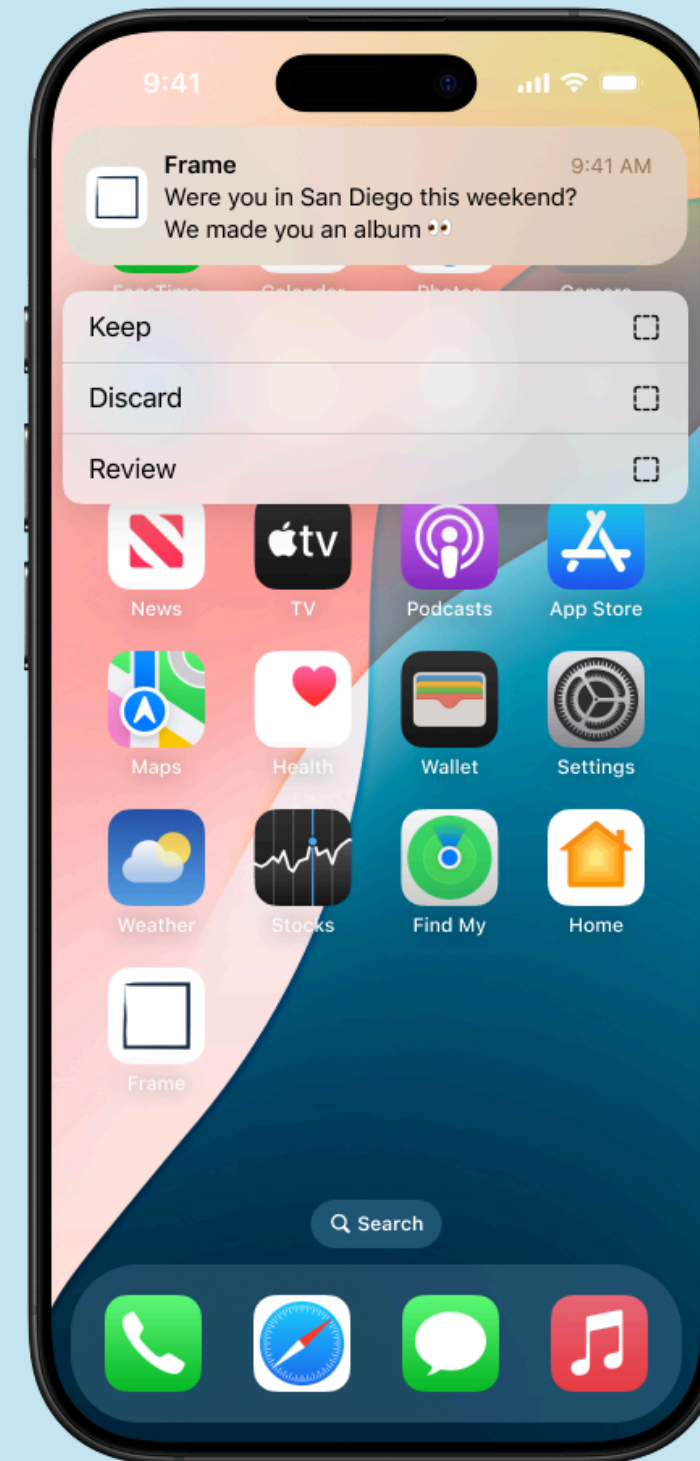
Before - Recovery & Confirmation

Violations addressed:

- **4** - Permanent Album Discard
- **3** - No Cancel on Edit Album

No Safety Nets:

- Discarding an auto-curated album was a one-tap permanent action. No confirmation, no undo.
- Edit Album had no "back out safely" path, edits committed on any navigation.



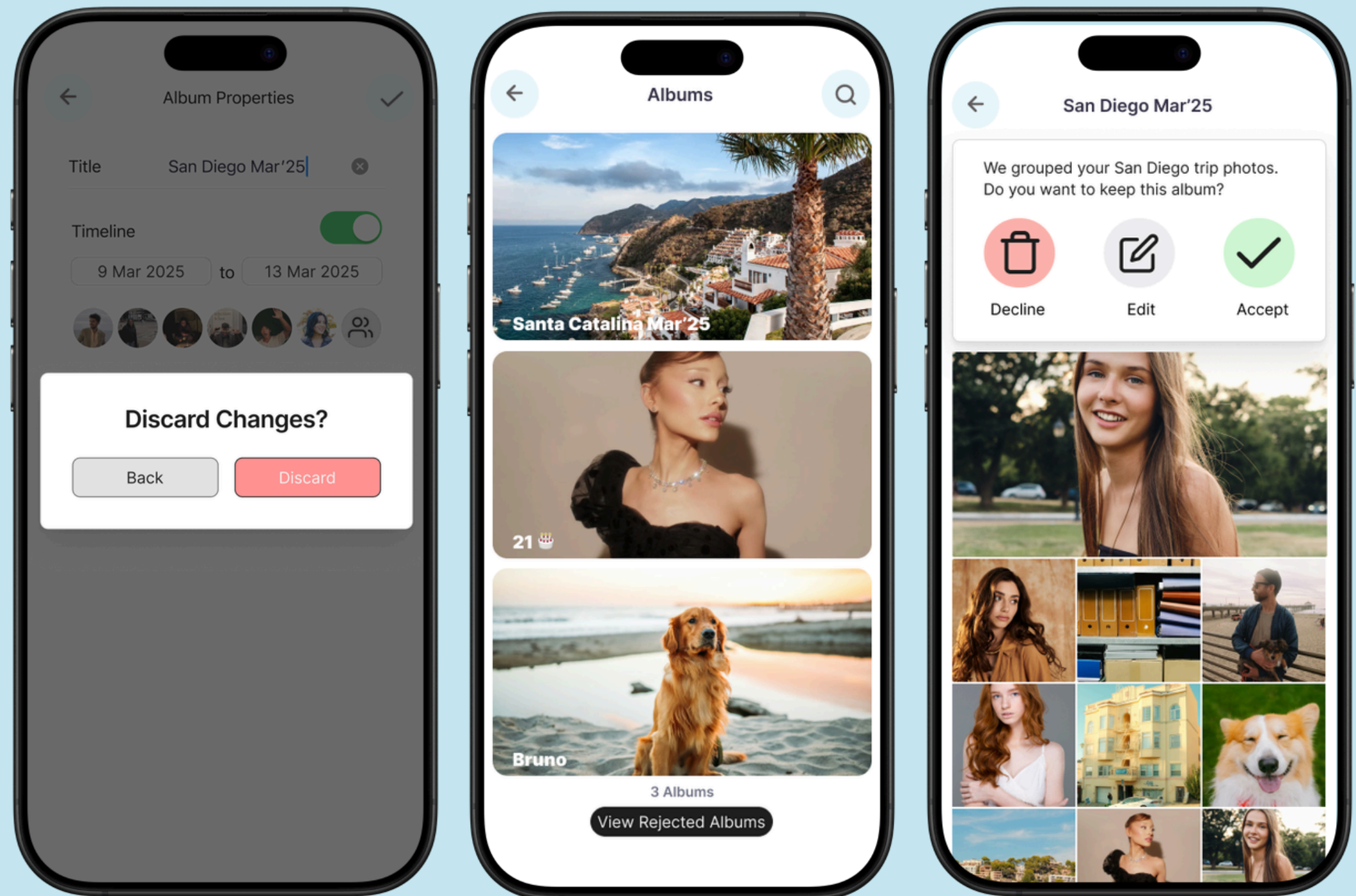
After - Recovery & Confirmation

Violations addressed:

- **4** - Permanent Album Discard
- **3** - No Cancel on Edit Album

Three Layers of Protection:

- Confirmation dialog on back-navigation
- 30-day recovery bin accessible from Albums page, and
- Recovery flow with Edit/Recover options.



Rationale: Usability Goals Impact

Learnability Impact

- Confirmation dialogs teach users that destructive actions are always two-step → reduces anxiety about exploring the UI freely.

Efficiency Impact

- Recovery bin eliminates the need for overcautious behavior → users make faster decisions knowing mistakes are reversible for 30 days.



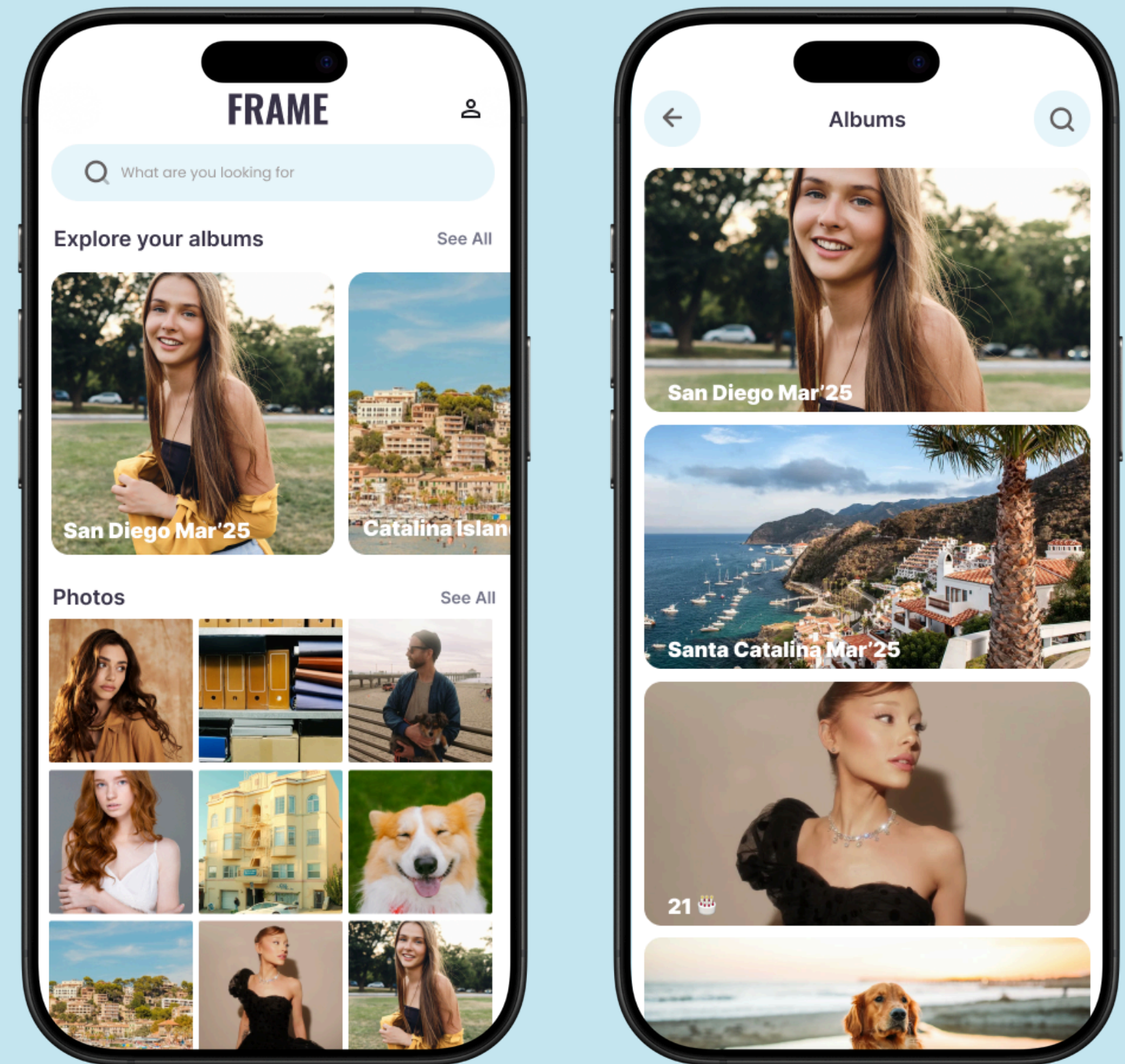
Before - In-App System Feedback

Violations addressed:

- **3** - No in-app indicator when Frame auto-creates an album

Invisible Background Work:

- Auto-album creation had zero in-app indication. If the push notification was dismissed, users had no way to discover Frame created an album.
- Albums page showed no distinction between new and existing content.



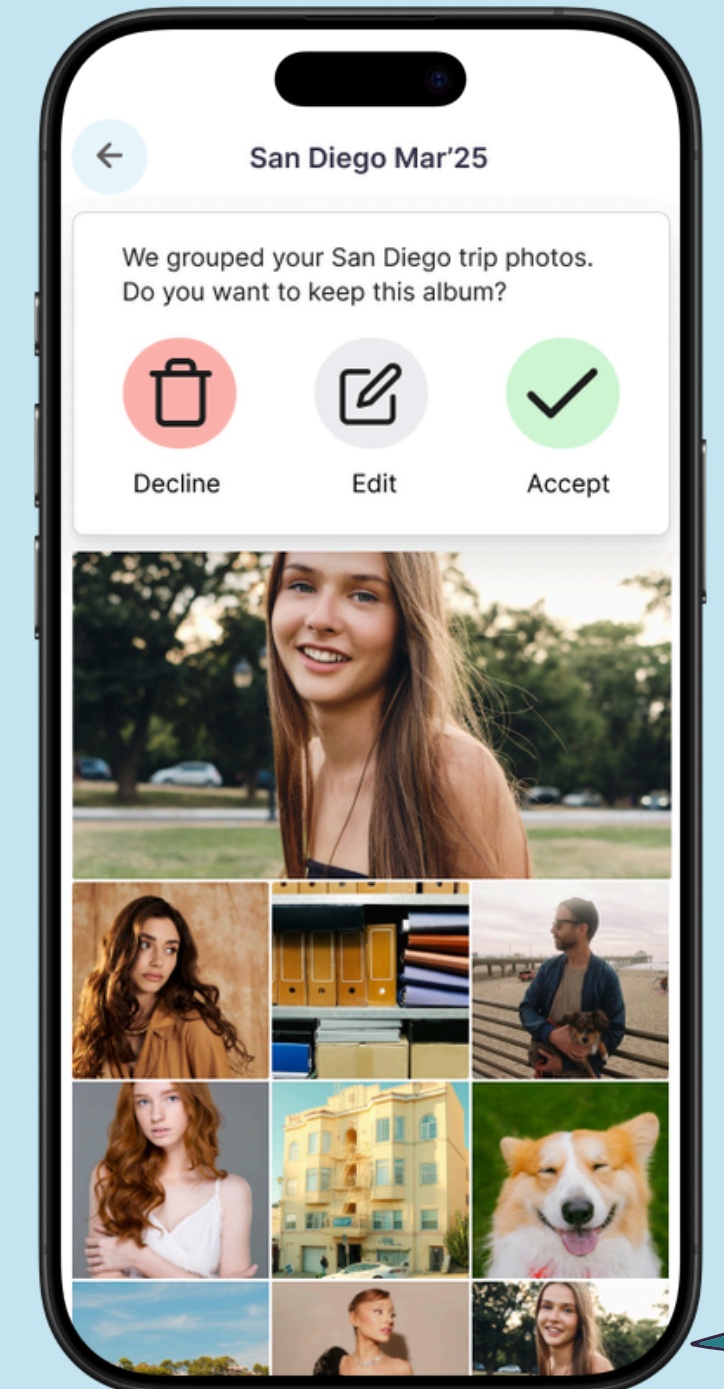
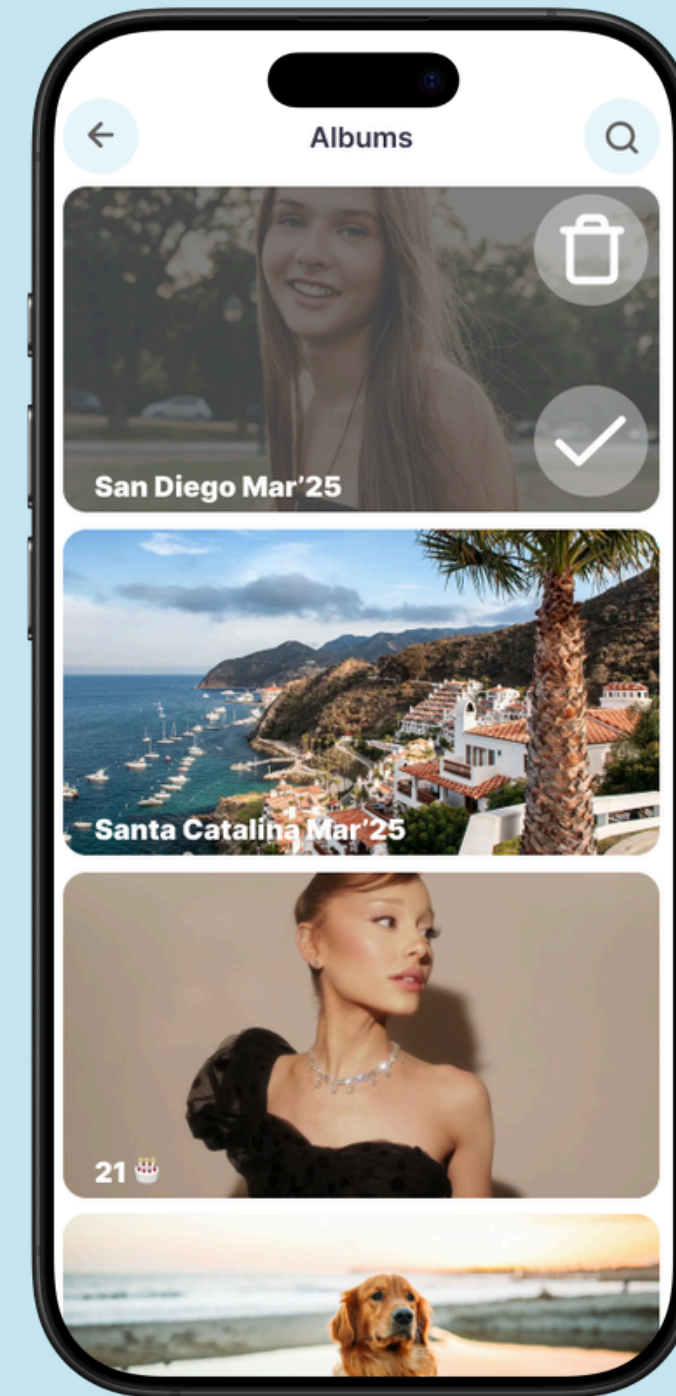
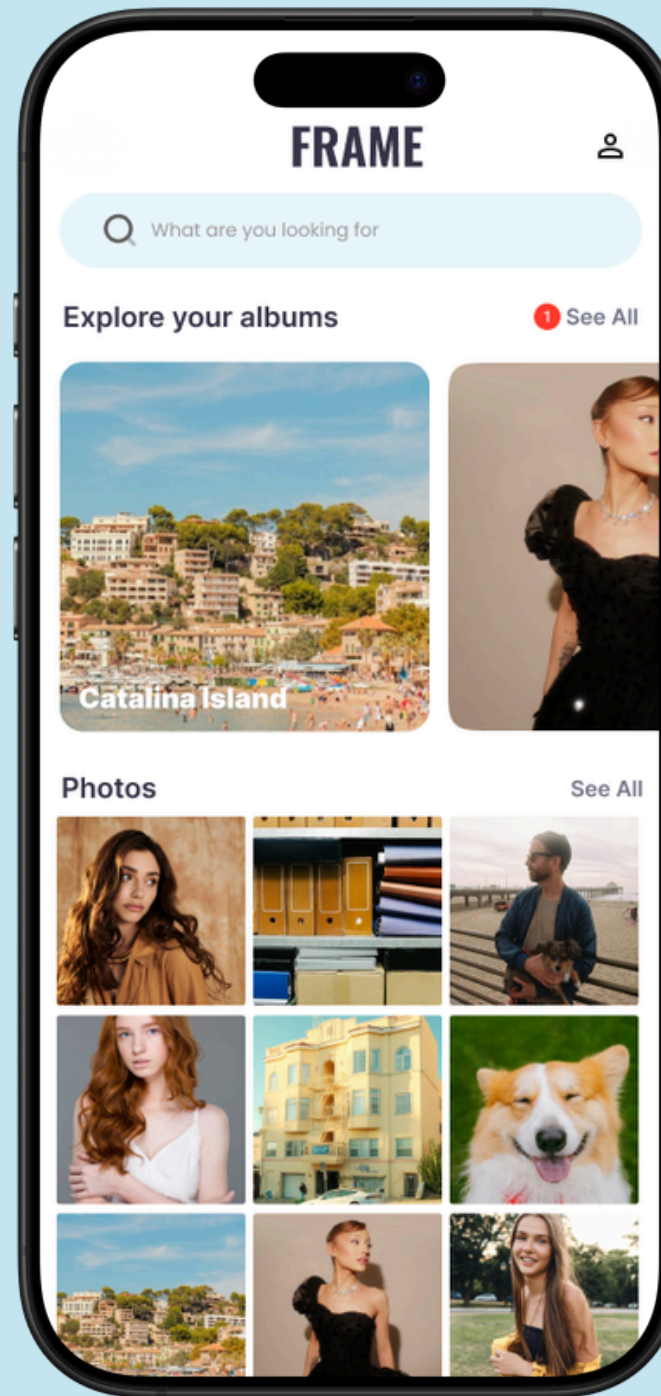
After - In-App System Feedback

Violations addressed:

- **3** - No in-app indicator when Frame auto-creates an album

Multi-channel awareness:

- Red badge on Dashboard's "See All" link
- New album cards with inline quick-action buttons at top of Albums page,
- Contextual messaging on review screen.



Rationale: Usability Goals Impact

Learnability Impact

- Badge + card pattern mirrors native iOS (App Store updates, Messages), reducing learning curve for new users.

Efficiency Impact

- Quick accept/reject buttons on the Albums card eliminate 2–3 navigation steps. Users decide without opening the album.



Before - Affordances & Recognizability

Violations addressed:

- **3** - inconsistent notification vocabulary, nameless avatars, and implicit "Review" action

Inconsistent Patterns:

- Task 1 notification: Accept / Decline
- Task 2 notification: Yes / No / Review (different vocabulary for similar actions)
- Edit Album people section: circular avatars only, no names
- Tapping "Review" on auto-album silently accepted it



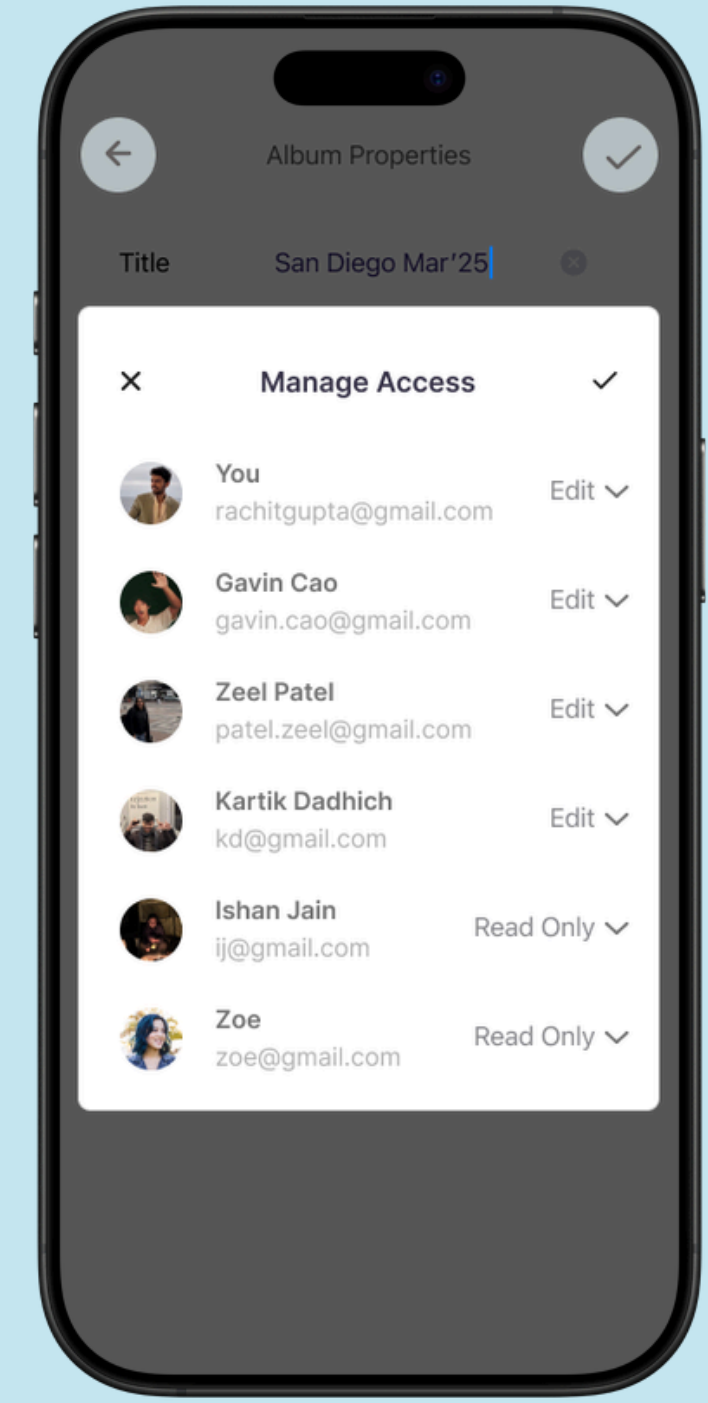
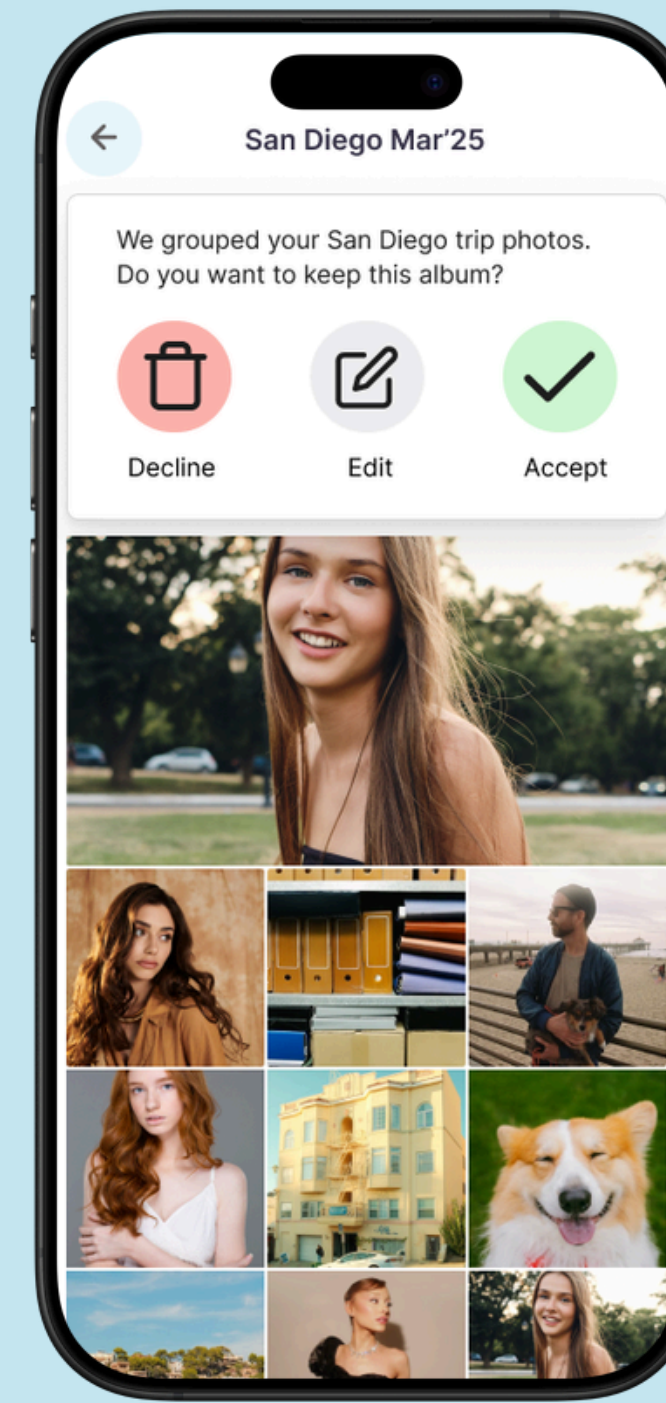
After - Affordances & Recognizability

Violations addressed:

- **3** - inconsistent notification vocabulary, nameless avatars, and implicit "Review" action

Consistent & Explicit:

- Both task types now use Accept / Decline, with Review/Edit
- Tapping people section opens full panel showing: profile photo, full name, email, and permission level (Edit vs. Read Only) for each person
- Clicking notification for auto-created album opens a dedicated review screen



Rationale: Usability Goals Impact

Learnability Impact

- Consistent vocabulary across tasks means learning one flow teaches the other. First-attempt success rate should increase.

Efficiency Impact

- Named people list eliminates the mental effort of avatar identification, especially for albums shared with acquaintances.



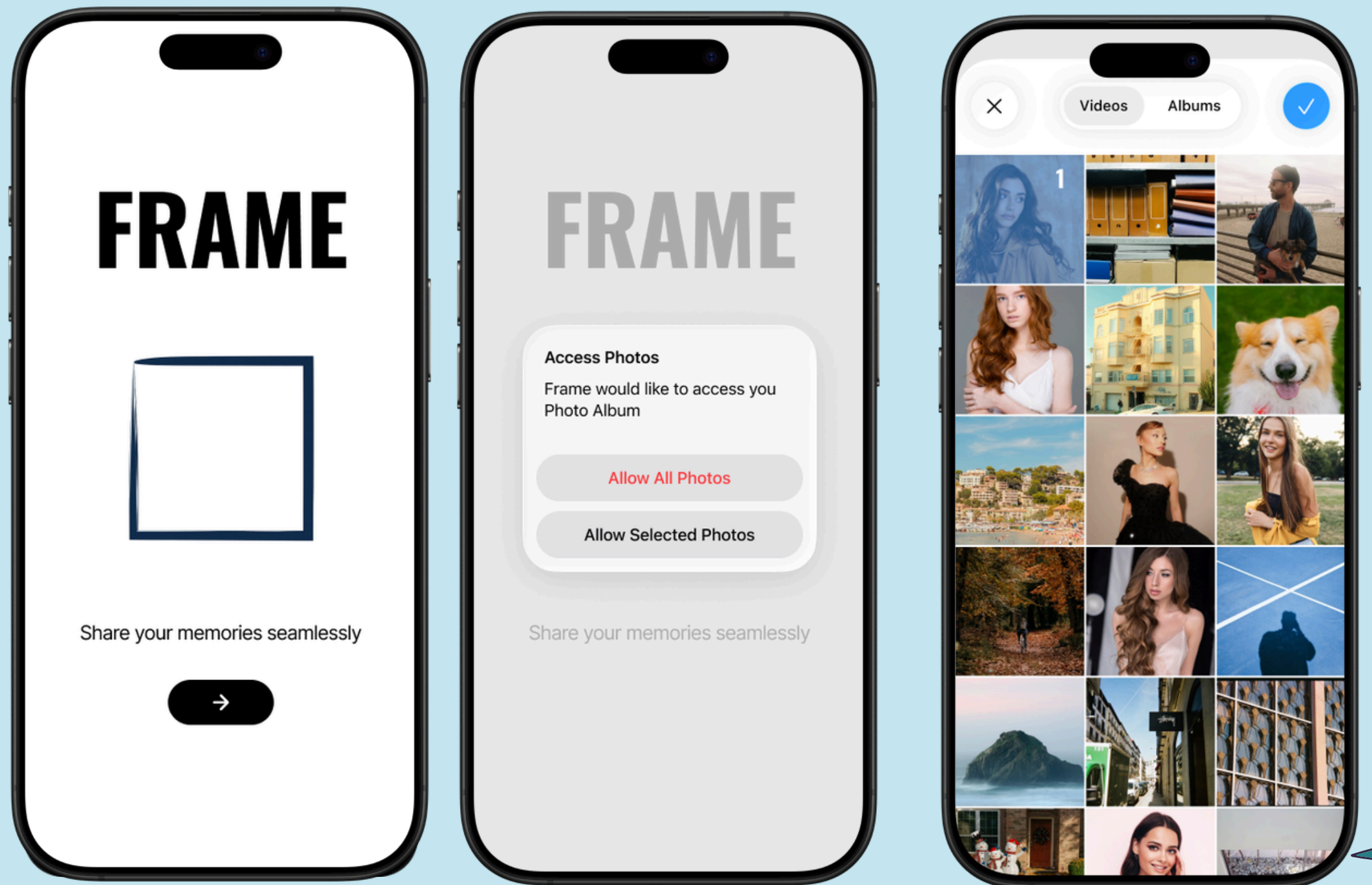
Before - Permission & Privacy Clarity

Violations addressed:

- 2 - No way to change photo permissions after initial setup & Landing page privacy messaging improved

Inconsistent Patterns:

- Initial setup: "Sync Frame with your gallery" technical wording
- Settings page: no way to change photo access after initial grant
- No explanation of what happens with photos before the user grants access



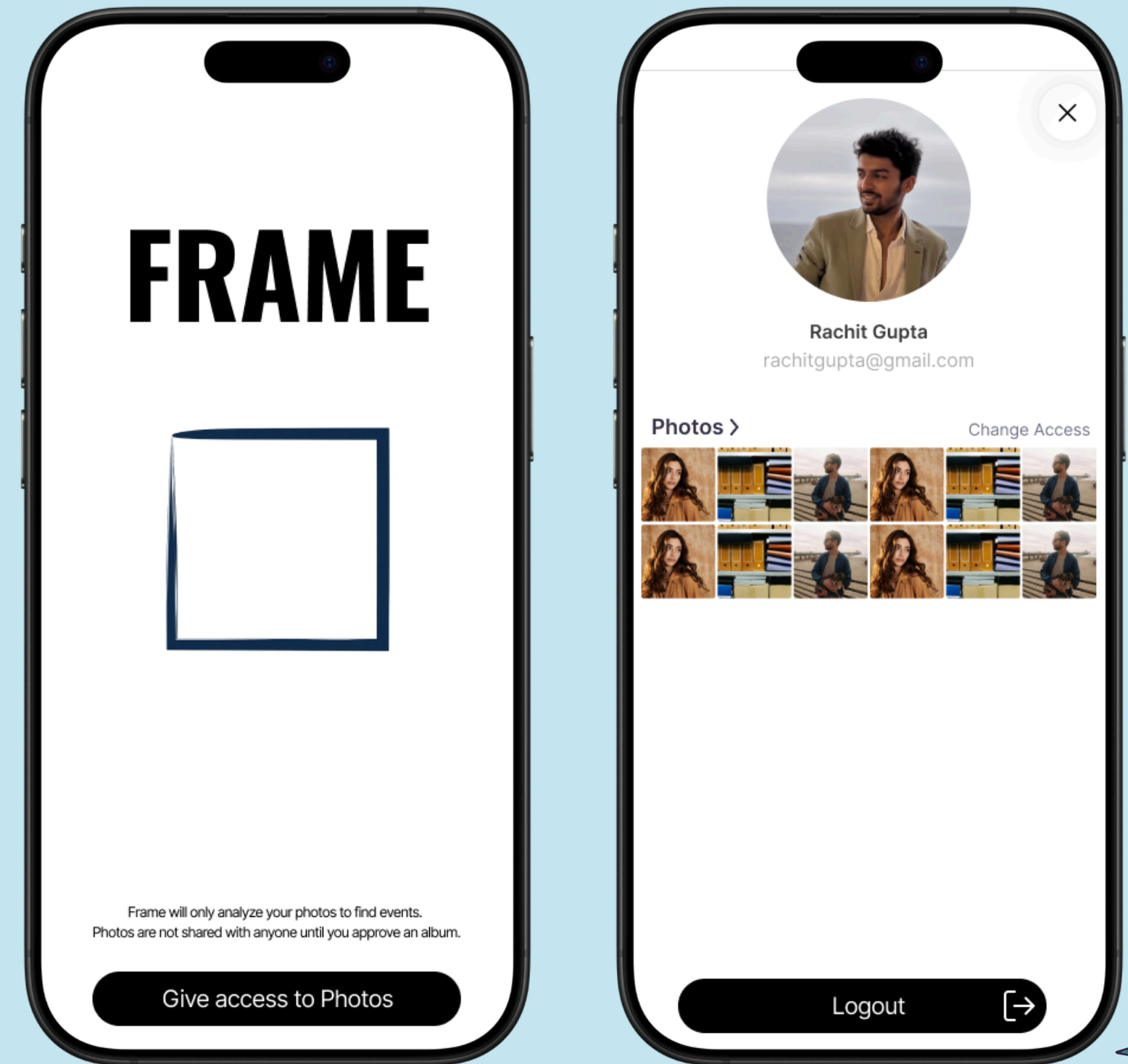
After - Permission & Privacy Clarity

Violations addressed:

- 2 - No way to change photo permissions after initial setup & Landing page privacy messaging improved

Inconsistent Patterns:

- Explicit text: "Frame will only analyze your photos to find events. Photos are not shared with anyone until you approve an album."
- Persistent access to modify photo permissions at any time, showing current photo selection with a "Change Access" button



Rationale: Usability Goals Impact

Learnability Impact

- Plain-language privacy explanation on first launch builds trust before any commitment.

Efficiency Impact

- Settings-based permission management means users never need to uninstall/reinstall to change access.



Usability Goal Progress Summary

Goal 1: Learnability (Intuitive Navigation)

Measurement: Navigation errors (misclicks per task), second-attempt errors

- Standardized notification actions
 - Eliminates vocabulary confusion between tasks → fewer first-attempt errors
- Confirmation dialogs on destructive actions
 - Two-step pattern teaches safe exploration → reduced anxiety-driven hesitation
- Named people in Manage Access
 - Recognition replaces recall → fewer "who is this?" moments
- Consistent review flow with explicit options
 - Users always know what each button will do → reduced misclicks



Usability Goal Progress Summary

Goal 2: Efficiency (Task Completion Speed)

Measurement: Time on task (seconds), from notification → success

- In-app album notifications + quick actions
 - Accept/reject from Albums page without opening album → saves 2-3 steps
- Removed Received Albums page
 - One fewer screen in the accept flow → faster completion
- Settings "Change Access"
 - Permission changes without app reinstall → minutes saved
- 30-day recovery bin
 - Users make faster decisions knowing mistakes are reversible



Design Values Impact

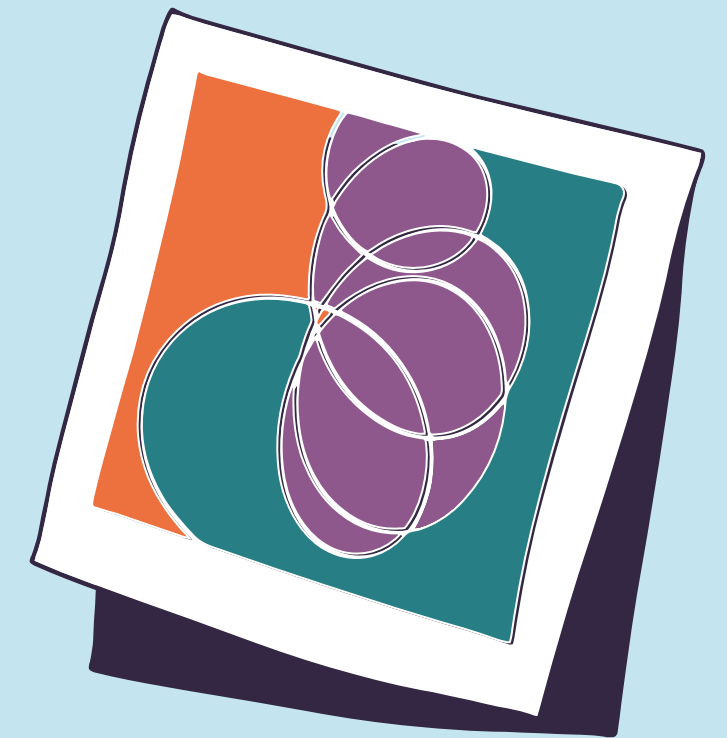
Every revision maps back to Frame's core promise: memories shouldn't be work.

Reducing Friction

- Removed the Received Albums page and added quick accept/reject actions directly from notifications — saving 2-3 steps per interaction. Settings now include "Change Access" so users can update photo permissions without reinstalling. Fewer screens, faster sharing.

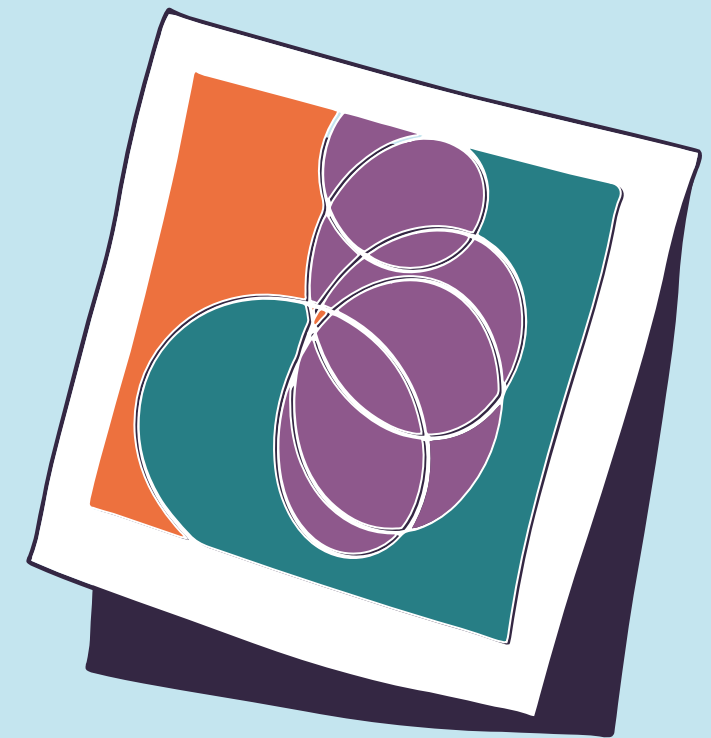
Reducing Anxiety

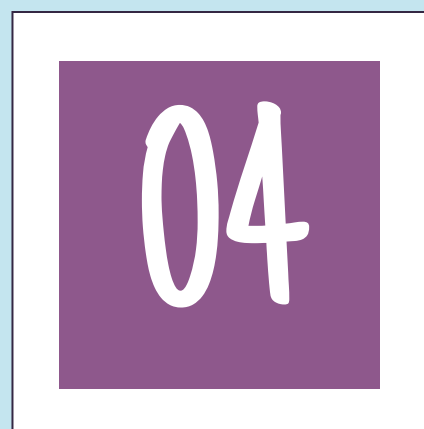
- Confirmation dialogs on destructive actions (discarding albums, declining invitations) and a 30-day recovery bin mean mistakes aren't permanent. When users know actions are reversible, they explore with confidence instead of hesitating.



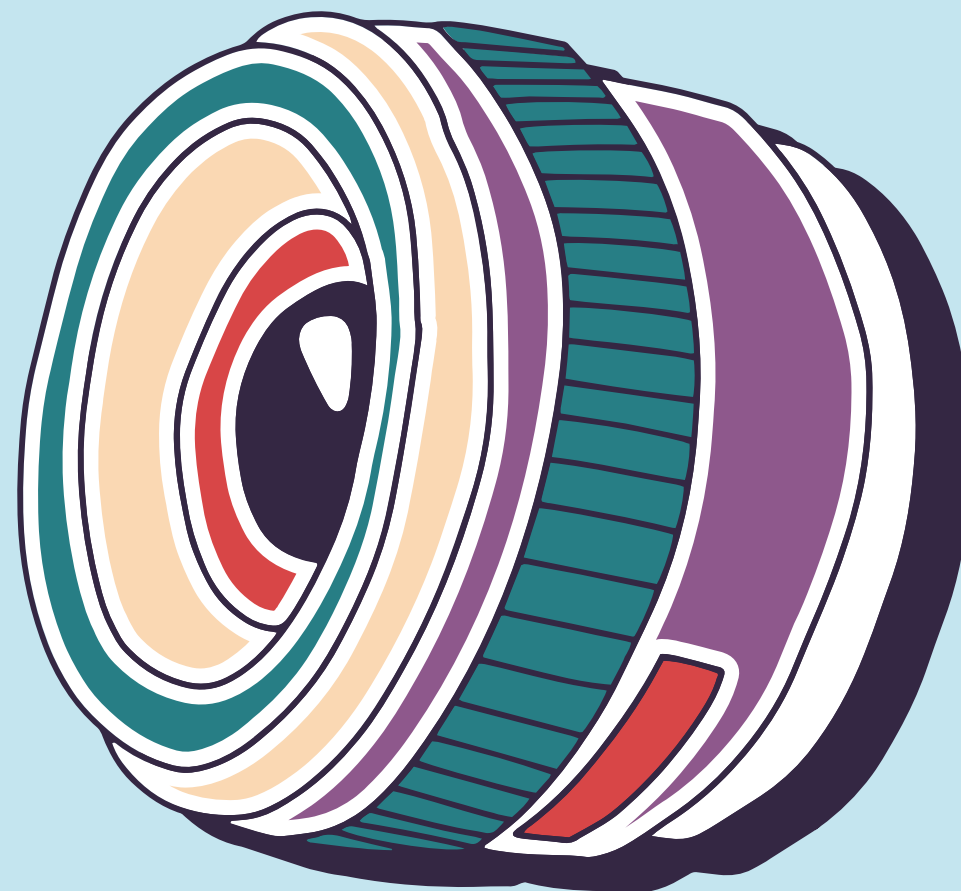
Next Steps

- Complete Settings "Change Permissions" flow
- Conduct usability testing with hi-fi prototype to measure actual impact on both goals
- Iterate on any remaining sev 1-2 violations that surface during testing





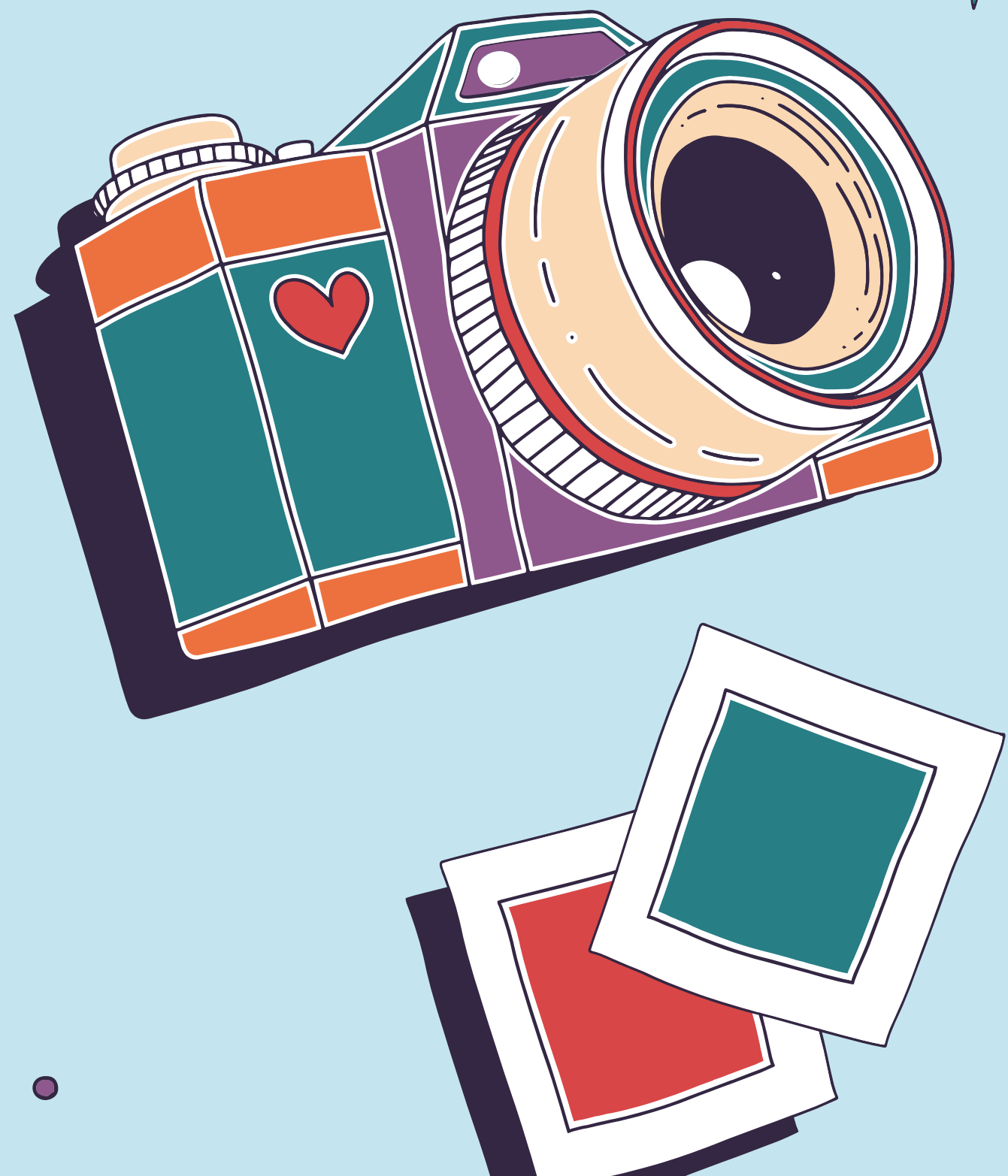
appendix





Figma Link





thank you!

